



This computer-generated image shows the ball of cells—the blastocyst—as it appears situated within the uterus. The outer ring of interconnected cells that will eventually form the placenta are clearly seen.

DOUBLING UP

As with many parents, you probably thought long and hard about trying to conceive your second child. There's no ideal age gap, but consider:

The pros of a small age gap:

- **You are in “baby mode”** and will be used to the routine and all aspects of baby care. You will have all the equipment you need from bottles to a stroller and crib.
- **A two-year-old** might find it easier to accept his new sibling than a four-year-old who is much more conscious of having the sole attention of his parents.
- There will be squabbles, but children close in age tend to play better together.

The cons of a small age gap:

- **It's tiring** caring for a one- or two-year-old while pregnant.
- **It can put a strain on your body** to have pregnancies close together.
- If you have a second baby before the first one can walk, you will be doing a lot of carrying, increasing the risk of backache.